

Canon Digital IXUS 330

A pricey deal

Canon's Digital IXUS 330 is probably the best looking 2 Megapixel digital camera we've seen. Its compact steel-aluminium body has an excellent metallic finish. The package includes a USB cable, Lithium-Ion battery, a battery charger, user manual and CD-ROM with all the drivers, and some photo editing software that will help you get started.

A 1.5-inch LCD screen shows a preview of the image you are about to shoot and allows you to browse through the user interface to change the camera settings. If you turn off the screen, you can use the optical viewfinder equipped with a 3x zoom lens for capturing distant objects. The camera can also be used to record short, 30-second videos at the lowest resolution. The videos can be viewed on a television screen using an AV connector.

The buttons on the camera are well placed and easy to operate. The dial to select the mode of the camera is conveniently placed at the top and can be rotated with the

thumb. There is also a groove at the back for resting the thumb, which helps to get a good grip and take photographs with a steady hand.

The IXUS 330 has excellent features and great compatibility with the PC as well as Canon's photo printer. However, the camera comes bundled with just an 8 MB Compact Flash (type 1) card, which limits its memory. Also, there is no internal memory. Considering this and the fact that it's a 2 Megapixel camera, its price (Rs 39,995) is too steep—you can easily get a 2 Megapixel camera for half that price.

SPECIFICATIONS

Dimensions 95x63x32 mm, weight 274 gm, CCD sensor, 2 Megapixel maximum 1600x1200 resolution, 3x zoom lens (35-105 mm), playback zoom, 1.5-inch LCD screen, 4:3 aspect ratio, aperture range F2.7-F4.7, 8 MB Compact Flash card, Canon Li-Ion NB-L1H 840 mAh Lithium-ion battery, JPEG storage format



Price: Rs 39,995
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Canon Digital IXUS 330		B+
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	

Creative Inspire 6600 6.1 speakers

Big boom!

Creative's new Inspire 6600 speakers are a treat for sound enthusiasts. The set consists of six satellite speakers and a woofer. It has an extra rear centre speaker that gives an amazing audio

realism from DirectSound 3D game titles, Dolby Digital EX DVD movies and digital music. There is a Creative Multi-Surround System up-mix control switch on the subwoofer to create a 6.1

sound field from a Sound Blaster 5.1 soundcard.

The speakers have an aesthetic appeal that adds value to the decor of the room—for a change, the woofer doesn't need to be hidden away. The satellites are slightly larger than speakers made by other manufacturers, but can still be managed easily. The stand for the centre channel speaker is designed specially to be placed on the monitor, so that it won't fall down. An extra replacement stand has also been provided. The satellite speakers are connected to the back of the sub-woofer through individ-

or needed. The bass gives a clean booming sound that fills the room—it is loud without being annoying. The sound effects in games such as *Quake III* and *Grand Prix 4* were reproduced realistically. However, these games will not exploit the full capability of this set with its additional rear centre speaker. The sound effects in DVD movies that support Dolby Digital EX format were reproduced precisely

and added an extra dimension to the movie experience. The clarity of vocals and instruments is



ual cables. The connection and setup is simple, as the cables are of different colours, making it easy to trace their path while connecting. The speaker wires are long enough so you can spread them out in a large room for a true surround experience.

We tested the speakers on the new Audigy2 Platinum soundcard. The six satellite speakers offered excellent sound quality without distortion, thanks to the flexible base, which helps dampen oscillations, thus reducing distortion.

The bass was of excellent quality up to pretty high sound levels. The higher frequencies were also reproduced faithfully. The speakers gave refined sound output even at 60 per cent absolute maximum volume. The bass started getting distorted at higher volume levels, but such sound levels would rarely be reached

also noteworthy.

The Creative Inspire 6600 is an ideal companion for the Audigy2 soundcard, producing superior accuracy in sound separation across the six speakers. This speaker set will complement other high-end components in your PC (DVD-ROM drive, large screen monitor, 6.1 channel soundcard) if you wish to make it an entertainment station.

SPECIFICATIONS

Total wattage of 120 W RMS, five 3-inch satellite speakers (8 W RMS each), one 4-inch front centre speaker (20 W RMS), one 6-inch 22 W RMS sub-woofer, electronically controlled satellites with high performance drivers, 6.1 positional audio, 35 Hz-20 KHz frequency range, 75 dB SNR, wired volume/bass control with headphone jack

Price: Rs 9,599
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Creative Inspire 6600		A-
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	